Ganjawi and Jalaluddin Rumi and history through the *Shahnameh*[4] of Ferdowsi. Although he had an affinity for poems, he had never shown any desire to compose one. All these characters are reflected deeply even in Babur's father Umar Shaikh.

In Babur's opinion, Umar was a man of justice . . . a characteristic which can be seen in the following instance. Once he heard the news of a caravan returning from Kara Khitai getting overwhelmed by snow in the mountains of Andijān. It was reported to him that only two out of the 1000 had been able to escape safely. He sent out his people to the place of disaster to collect the abandoned goods. Although the legatee of those who succumbed to the disaster lived far away in Khurāsān and Samarkand, and he was seeing economic disasters, Umar arranged to call them all and return their properties in a couple of years. Babur found him to be a truthful and generous leader. He was sociable, eloquent, sweet-spoken, audacious and bold. In Babur's words, his swordsmanship was well-known and stories of it spread far. It is said that he used to lead from the front and never liked to be shielded by his soldiers. He had shown his skills and bravery at the gates of Akhsi and Shahrukhiya.

Though he was a good wielder of the sword, he was a mediocre archer, but of all, he was too strong at using the fist. Babur says that hardly any could bear his blow. The ambitious Umar brought peace through wars.

Although Umar's father Abu followed religion with utmost sincerity and it had quite a good impact on him, he was an alcoholic in his young years. It was due to childhood learnings that he could recite the Qur'an, Sirrah and Hadiths quite eloquently. As he grew, intoxicating confects became an essential part of his life, while alcohol got distanced. Perhaps it had begun to affect him mentally. His sexual desires were high, and he spent enough time quenching them. Though he was not very fond of playing games, he was a skilled hand at the draught board.

Battles have always been part and parcel of Tuks[5] life and it was no different for Umar Shaikh. Of all the battles fought, three were crucial in his life. Interestingly, his first ranged battle was with the Khān of Mongols, Yunus Khān. The Khān married his daughter to Umar in AD 1475. This battle was fought in the region, north of Andijān on the banks of Syr River at a place called the Goat-Leap. The place had got such a name because the foothills narrowed down the flow of water so much that even a goat could leap across.

Yunus Khān had defeated Umar Shaikh in this war. The latter was made a prisoner. But Yunus showed generosity and let him travel back to his place in Andijān safely. The battle took its name after its location and thus has been known as the Battle of the Goat-Leap. Umar Shaikh's second major battle